

Nifty League
Game Name: **WEN**
GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT v02
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In brief:

- WEN is a game of timing and reflex.
- The purpose of the game is to try and hit as many baseballs (launched from a baseball machine) as possible in a row to get a high score, as time goes on the game speed increases, ramping up the difficulty.
- The ball machine launches balls at irregular intervals, keeping the player on their toes.
- One hit = 1 point.
- Game Over is when the player misses a ball and has no extra lives remaining.

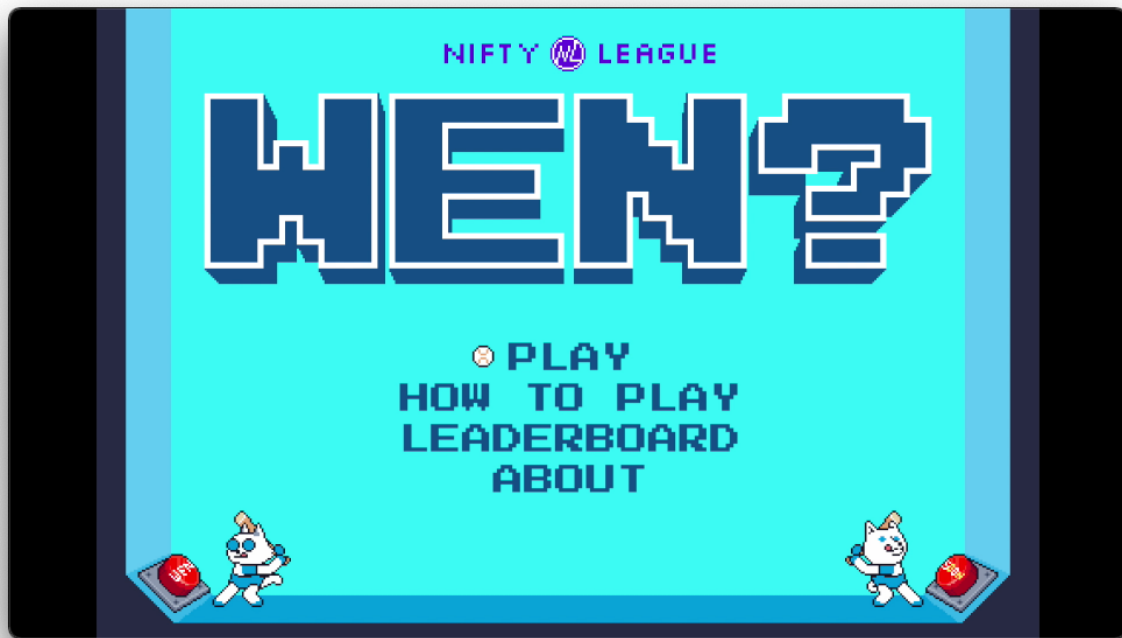
Context:

- The game is in response to the crypto community who often ask 'WEN' to ask 'when is feature/game being shipped?'
- In this context, WEN means 'when is the ball being launched?'
- WEN is meant to be a simple game to understand that anyone can pick up and play, with the main mechanics being a 1-button game in the vein of *Canabalt* and the *Google Offline Dinosaur Game*, that tests the player's response reflexes.
- WEN is also meant to be a funny game, with 'Wen?' questions from the player being answered by the ball-launching machine with 'Soon'.
- The game is both an in-joke but also a functional and fun game.

Additionally:

- The game is meant to be free to play for anyone even without a Degen to use one of the generic free-2-play robot Degens, but if the player connects their wallet, the game will give the player the option of playing with one of their owned Degens.
- The team may vote to rather have this game playable once per day for Degen holders, with rewards offered for high scorers, in an effort to get Degen holders returning every day to play the game.
- I am ok to skip the ability for the player to select their own Degen for simplicity's sake.
- After Game Over, the game is meant to be quick to start again so that people can keep going with the game loop.

- There is a global leaderboard that shows the top scorers of WEN.
- The game relies on tight timing and is single-player, so lag should not be an issue because the actual input and response isn't reliant on network and thus shouldn't be affected by lag once the game is loaded.
- The game uses no new Degen sprites, and uses Degen sprite sheets from Nifty Smashers.
- The only new sprite sheets will be the free-2-play generic robot characters, 1 for each of the 6 tribes.



Title Screen

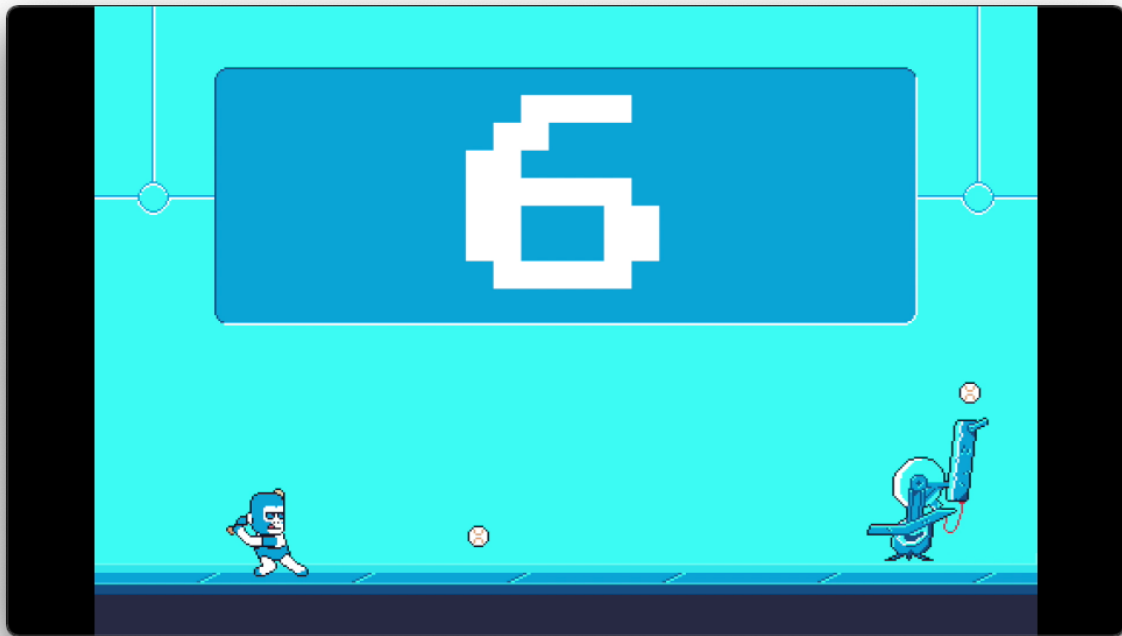
- The game name WEN is displayed on screen.
- The selectable MENU options (with UP and DOWN) are:
 - > PLAY
 - HOW TO PLAY
 - LEADERBOARD
 - ABOUT
- If PLAY is selected, the game progresses to a CHARACTER SELECTION screen.
- On the CHARACTER SELECTION screen is text SELECT YOUR DEGEN.
- On the CHARACTER SELECTION screen is a CONNECT WALLET (OPTIONAL) button.

- The text displays CONNECT YOUR WALLET TO SELECT DEGENS YOU OWN, OTHERWISE CHOOSE FROM ONE OF SATOSHI'S TRAINING BOTS! USE LEFT AND RIGHT TO CYCLE THROUGH DEGENS.
- If the player does not connect their wallet, then 1 of 6 TRAINING BOTS are selectable.
- If the player does have their wallet connected, then any Degen(s) they own are selectable.
- If the player does have their wallet connected but no DEGENs are found, text displays NO DEGENS FOUND IN WALLET! PLEASE SELECT ONE OF SATOSHI'S TRAINING BOTS.
- Player selects PLAY to start the game.

- If player selects HOW TO PLAY a TEXT SCREEN displays explaining how the game works:
 Press SPACE or A on your controller to swing.
 Hit as many balls as you can!
 See if you can get a high score and make it into the TOP 10 GLOBAL LEADERBOARD!
- There is a BACK option to return to the MENU.

- If player selects LEADERBOARD, the TOP 10 GLOBAL LEADERBOARD is displayed.
- There is a BACK option to return to the MENU.

- If player selects ABOUT a TEXT SCREEN displays some ABOUT info:
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www.niftyleague.com
- Player can click the website link to open the Nifty League website in a new window.
- There is a BACK option to return to the MENU.
- If player clicks anywhere else, they are taken back to the MENU.



Gameplay Mechanics:

- The player is on the left of the screen.
- The ball pitching machine is on the right of the screen.
- At random intervals, the ball pitching machine shoots a ball to the player on the left.
- The player presses the swing button (space on keyboard, A on controller) to swing their bat.
- HIT PAUSE: The final frame of the player's swing is held momentarily during which time the player cannot trigger the hit animation again. This is to prevent the player from spamming the hit button & hit animation continuously.

Hitting the Ball:

- If the ball is within the correct proximity (to be determined during testing to get a good feel of what feels right) of the player, the player hits the ball and scores 1 point.
- It would be cool to get a simple physics engine in place that hits the ball at varying degrees of up or down depending on how close the ball is to the player - closer to the player = ball gets hit more vertically. Further away from the player = ball gets hit flatter. Or just hits the ball back at random angles.
- If ball does not get hit off screen, ball remains on screen for some time, with a maximum of 5 balls on ground before they disappear for new balls.

- At the start of the game and immediately after hitting the ball, a line of WEN QUESTION TEXT appears above the player's head as though the Player were asking a question, eg 'WEN WITHDRAWALS?' or 'WEN TENNIS?'
- The WEN QUESTION TEXT is pulled at random from a document that we can edit that has a number of options for the player to 'say'.
- The BALL PITCHING MACHINE responds with 'SOON'.
- There is a random length of pause before the BALL PITCHING MACHINE fires a ball at the player.
- As the player successfully hits more balls, the GAME SPEED gradually increases.
- The intervals of the balls being launched is at random to prevent the player from getting into an easy rhythm.
- The RATE and SPEED can get up to ridiculously (and hopefully hilariously) fast levels as far as the player is able to keep hitting the balls at the correct times.
- The player's default rest position is in a charged bat position with the bat ready to swing.
- The game cannot be WON, the SPEED and FIRING RATE of the ball keeps increasing to ridiculous levels until the player misses the ball enough to result in GAME OVER.

Missing the Ball:

- If the player presses the hit button too late, the ball flies past the player and the game is over. Game speed resets to zero.
- The player falls and HITS THE GROUND character animation plays and the player flies left, as though the ball hit them and they fell over.
- If the game is over, GAME OVER is displayed on screen, and then the global leaderboard, with the options being TRY AGAIN and QUIT, with TRY AGAIN being the default action so the player can quickly restart the game.
- The LEADERBOARD displays the TOP 10, with 3 columns:
RANK | NAME | SCORE |
- On TRY AGAIN, the counter starts at zero and the GAME SPEED is reset to zero.
- If a player manages to achieve a global Top 10 high score, their name will display with information about their gameplay session.
- If a player has connected their wallet, the [NAME] field will display the wallet name, or their associated .ETH name.
- If a player has not connected their wallet, the [NAME] field will allow the player to type in 3 digits for a name eg 'BOB'.
- If a player selects QUIT, the game quits back to the TITLE SCREEN.